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Techpreneur Obodugo builds innovative platform



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began in an unlikely place, a seminary high school. Admitted as the top candidate among over 700 applicants, he spent six years there on scholarship, learning discipline, reflection, and the power of influence through ideas.

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"It was a place that taught silence and intellectual rigor," he recalled. "I learned that ideas could command respect without a raised voice, a lesson that still shapes how I build and communicate."

A naturally gifted learner, Obodugo's teenage years were marked by a deep curiosity about patterns and systems. He and a close group of friends often gathered to solve problems and debate concepts — a self-made think tank he now describes as his "local Vienna Circle."

By the time he entered university to study mechanical engineering, he had already taught himself software programming. "I realised what fascinated me most wasn't machinery but systems that mirrored human behavior, the interplay between structure and spontaneity," he said.

Over the past decade, Obodugo has built and led engineering teams across Africa, Europe, and the Middle East, gaining the cross-cultural experience that would later define GistPool's architecture.

He currently leads engineering at Derayah Finance in Saudi Arabia, overseeing large-scale trading systems. Previously, he served as a Founding Engineer at HitPay, a Singapore-based payment platform now used across Southeast Asia, and at Rollee Finance in Europe, where he helped design open-banking and income verification systems for clients across the EU.

In West Africa, he built MySub, a group-payments platform that scaled to tens of thousands of users without venture capital funding. "That experience taught me agility and cultural fit," he said. "We grew on trust and word of mouth, not marketing spend."

His admission into Toptal, the global network for the top 3% of engineers, gave him access to high-calibre global projects and further shaped his engineering discipline. "It exposed me to standards that made reliability my most important feature," he said.